Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	$209.00 ▼ 0.02%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$220.00	$106.37 – $212.94	$502.24B

PLTR: Parked at Highs as AI/Defense Policy Tailwinds Hold

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR is basically flat today at $209 but just ripped ~9% in a week (from $192 to $209) and is sitting at 96% of its 52-week range — translation: the stock is pressed right up against its all-time high with no news to justify today's pause. That usually means buyers are exhausted and we're waiting for the next catalyst (likely Q3 earnings in early November).
- The options market is flashing a yellow light — big unusual put buying at $205, $207.50, and $210 strikes expiring this month, totaling ~$10M in notional (fancy term for "dollar value of the bets"). Someone with real money is paying for downside protection right at current levels.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the setup: PLTR has become the poster child for the "government AI buildout" trade, and the stock is reflecting that — a $502B market cap on roughly $4.6B in expected revenue means investors are paying over $100 for every $1 of sales. That only works if the political tailwinds keep blowing hard, which so far they are: the Trump administration's AI executive orders have prioritized "American AI champions" for federal contracts, and PLTR is explicitly one of them. But the unusual put buying tells me institutions are hedging — not selling outright, just buying insurance into earnings. The read-through: smart money thinks the business is fine but the price has gotten ahead of itself short-term. Watch the Q3 print — anything less than a commercial revenue acceleration and a raised guide, and this stock gives back 10-15% fast.

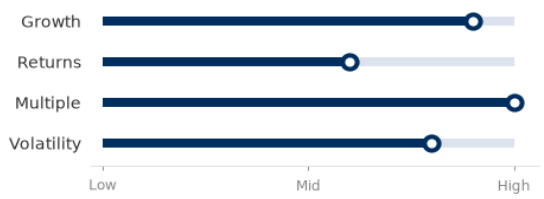
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Three policy threads matter for PLTR right now: (1) The FY2027 defense budget negotiations in Congress are pushing toward another record (~$900B+), with explicit carve-outs for AI/software modernization — PLTR's Maven and TITAN programs are direct beneficiaries. (2) The administration's AI executive orders continue to favor domestic "trusted" vendors for federal data work, which is essentially a moat PLTR didn't have to build itself. (3) Watch the ongoing debate around federal procurement reform — if "commercial item" rules get expanded (making it easier for software companies to sell to the government without jumping through traditional defense-contractor hoops), PLTR wins big. The headwind to watch: any Democratic pushback on surveillance/ICE-related contracts if political winds shift in the 2026 midterms.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data	
Price (USD)	**$209.00**
12M Price Target	**$220.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+5.3%**
Market Cap	**$502.24B**
FY2026E Revenue	**$4,600M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$6,100M**
FY2026E EPS	**$0.68**
FY2027E EPS	**$0.95**
Fwd P/E	**307.0x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

PLTR — Palantir Technologies Inc. | October 12, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$225.00**	$210.00	**$185.00**
6 Months	**$260.00**	$215.00	**$160.00**
1 Year	**$290.00**	$220.00	**$140.00**
2 Years	**$360.00**	$250.00	**$120.00**
5 Years	**$500.00**	$320.00	**$100.00**
10 Years	**$800.00**	$450.00	**$80.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.4% today, +4% week) and Consumer Staples (+1.2%) — that's a defensive rotation, meaning money is moving to safer, cash-flowing businesses. Energy is also catching a bid from geopolitical tensions and the administration's "drill baby drill" policy stance.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services is flat-to-down on the week, and notably Tech isn't in the top movers — that's a tell that the AI trade is taking a breather after a huge run.

ROTATION WATCH: Money rotating into defensives while high-multiple tech pauses is a classic late-cycle move — not bearish yet, but it means PLTR has to earn its next leg up with actual numbers, not just vibes.

RELATED PLAY: If the government AI thesis keeps working, look at the "picks and shovels" plays — defense primes with AI exposure (LMT, RTX) and the hyperscalers that host PLTR's workloads (MSFT, AMZN) all benefit without the nosebleed valuation.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ANET (Arista Networks): Networking gear for AI data centers — the plumbing of the AI buildout, growing fast at a more reasonable multiple.
- LDOS (Leidos): Defense IT services play that benefits from the same federal AI/modernization spend as PLTR, at ~20x earnings instead of 300x.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR has been LEADING its peer group — up ~95% from the 52-week low — which is why I'm cautious here. When a stock leads this hard, it also tends to correct hardest when sentiment shifts. The leadership tells us the thesis is working; the extreme valuation tells us a lot of good news is already in the price.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: $170-180 on broad market pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Two straight quarters of US commercial growth deceleration, or a major DoD contract loss

Hedging: Buy out-of-the-money puts into earnings; pair-trade long PLTR / short a richer-multiple AI software name

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